

unfortunately there is no HDMI support and hence pairing it up with HD displays won't be possible.

Things get really interesting when you look at the slightly modified software development tool kit (SDK) which gives a few pointers as to what the future revisions of this OS and device might be capable of. One feature that generated a lot of noise was the presence of hooks in the SDK to accept and decline video conference, flip a video feed and view video calls in full screen or partial screen. The first of these indicate the presence of a camera in future revisions while the ability to flip it is a strong indicator of a front facing one. The device already has support for Wi-Fi and 3G and hence effectively putting a very strong portable video-conferencing solution in your hand if the camera feature is implemented.

We might be making a mountain of the mole, but the ability to view the video in partial screen is a definite pointer towards having multi-tasking ability which the current version of the OS surprising lacks. Apple fan boys might finally have an answer to the “lack of multi-tasking” allegations, though we won't suggest holding your breath for it.

The SDK also has primitive support for SMS and given the fact that the iPad use microSIM for its 3G capabilities, it can be an indication of its ability to be used as a phone. Typing messages via the huge on-screen keyboard would definitely be a heaven for SMS Junkies.

Overall, this version definitely has its limitation given that it was intended to be a netbook replacement instead of small handheld device. But as the SDK points, future revisions look very promising. Apple is known to bring major overhauls with upgrades and addition of video conferencing and phone capabilities to this OS would make the iPad a must have in your backpack device. 